

Acme Corp - Remote Work Policy

Policy ID: ACME-HR-002

Effective Date: January 1, 2026

Last Revised: January 1, 2026

Approved By: Sarah Chen, VP of Human Resources

Applies To: All employees eligible for remote or hybrid work arrangements

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the guidelines and expectations for remote and hybrid work arrangements at Acme Corp. Our goal is to provide flexibility while maintaining productivity, collaboration, and security standards.

2. Work Arrangement Types

Acme Corp offers three work arrangement types:

Arrangement	Description	Office Requirement
On-Site	Employee works from an Acme Corp location	5 days/week in office
Hybrid	Employee splits time between office and remote work	2-3 days/week in office (as determined by manager)
Fully Remote	Employee works from an approved remote location	Quarterly in-person meetings required

The default arrangement for most positions is Hybrid. Fully remote arrangements require written approval from the employee's department head and the VP of Human Resources.

3. Eligibility

3.1 General Eligibility

Remote and hybrid work eligibility is determined based on:

- Job function: Roles that require physical presence (e.g., facilities, lab work, reception) are not eligible for remote work.
- Performance: Employees must be in good standing with a performance rating of "Meets Expectations" or above in their most recent review.

- Tenure: New employees must complete their 90-day onboarding period on-site before becoming eligible for hybrid or remote work arrangements.
- Manager approval: All remote work arrangements require direct manager approval.

3.2 Temporary Remote Work

Employees may request temporary remote work (up to 10 consecutive business days) for personal circumstances such as:

- Home repairs or maintenance requiring presence
- Caring for a family member (not covered by FMLA or sick leave)
- Inclement weather or transportation disruptions

Temporary remote work requests must be approved by the employee's direct manager and do not require HR approval.

4. Remote Work Agreement

All employees with permanent hybrid or fully remote arrangements must sign a Remote Work Agreement that covers:

1. Designated work location(s)
2. Expected work schedule and core hours
3. Equipment and technology requirements
4. Data security and confidentiality obligations
5. Workspace safety and ergonomics acknowledgment
6. Communication and availability expectations

The Remote Work Agreement is reviewed and renewed annually or whenever there is a significant change in the employee's role or work arrangement.

5. Work Schedule and Availability

5.1 Core Hours

All employees, regardless of work arrangement, must be available during Acme Corp core hours: 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM in their designated time zone (as specified in their Remote Work Agreement).

5.2 Flexible Hours

Outside of core hours, employees may flex their remaining work hours to complete their standard 40-hour work week (or their contractually agreed hours for part-time employees). Any regularly recurring non-standard schedule must be documented in the Remote Work Agreement.

5.3 Time Zone Considerations

Fully remote employees in different time zones must coordinate with their team to ensure adequate overlap with core hours. A minimum of 3 hours of overlap with the majority of the team is required.

6. Equipment and Technology

6.1 Company-Provided Equipment

Acme Corp will provide the following equipment to all remote and hybrid employees:

- Laptop computer (refreshed every 3 years)
- External monitor (one 27-inch display)
- Keyboard and mouse
- Headset with microphone for video conferencing

All company-provided equipment remains the property of Acme Corp and must be returned upon separation from the company.

6.2 Home Office Stipend

Fully remote employees receive a one-time \$500 home office setup stipend upon approval of their remote work arrangement. This stipend may be used for:

- Ergonomic chair or standing desk
- Desk lamp or lighting
- Organizational supplies
- Other workspace improvements

Additionally, all remote and hybrid employees receive a monthly \$75 internet and utilities stipend to offset the cost of working from home.

6.3 Co-Working Spaces

Employees who prefer to work from a co-working space may do so, but Acme Corp does not reimburse

co-working space membership fees. Exceptions may be made for employees in areas where reliable home internet is unavailable, subject to manager and HR approval.

6.4 Technology Requirements

Remote employees must maintain:

- A reliable high-speed internet connection (minimum 25 Mbps download / 5 Mbps upload)
- A quiet, private workspace suitable for video calls and focused work
 - An up-to-date operating system and all required security software (see Information Security Policy, ACME-IT-001)

7. Communication Expectations

7.1 Responsiveness

- Slack/Chat: Respond within 30 minutes during core hours for direct messages; channel messages within 2 hours.
- Email: Respond within 4 business hours during working hours.
- Urgent matters: Use phone calls for time-sensitive issues; all employees must keep their phone number updated in the company directory.

7.2 Meetings

- All team meetings default to video-on unless otherwise agreed by the team.
- Remote employees must join meetings on time and from a location with appropriate internet bandwidth and minimal background noise.
- Hybrid employees are expected to attend in-person meetings when they are in the office.

7.3 Status Updates

Employees must keep their Slack status updated to reflect their availability (e.g., "In a meeting," "Away - back at 2 PM," "On PTO"). Calendar availability must be kept current in Google Calendar.

8. Performance and Accountability

8.1 Output-Based Evaluation

Remote and hybrid employees are evaluated based on outcomes and deliverables, not hours logged. Managers and employees will establish clear objectives, deadlines, and key results.

8.2 Regular Check-Ins

- Weekly 1:1 meetings between the employee and their direct manager are required for all remote and hybrid employees.
- Daily standups (15 minutes, via video) are standard for engineering and product teams.

8.3 Revocation of Remote Work Privileges

Remote or hybrid work privileges may be revoked if:

- Performance falls below "Meets Expectations"
- Communication and availability standards are not met
- Security policies are violated
- The business need changes (e.g., team restructuring, project requirements)

Revocation requires written notice with at least 15 business days for the employee to transition back to on-site work.

9. Workspace Safety and Ergonomics

Remote employees are responsible for maintaining a safe home workspace. Acme Corp recommends:

- An adjustable chair with lumbar support
- A desk at proper height for ergonomic typing
- Adequate lighting to reduce eye strain
- Cable management to prevent trip hazards

Employees may request an ergonomic assessment through HR, which can be conducted virtually via video call.

10. Tax and Legal Considerations

Employees are responsible for understanding the tax implications of working remotely, particularly if working from a state or jurisdiction different from their designated office location. Acme Corp will process payroll taxes based on the employee's primary work location as documented in their Remote Work Agreement.

Employees must notify HR immediately if they change their primary remote work location, especially across state or national borders.

11. International Remote Work

Working from outside the United States is not permitted for more than 15 consecutive business days without prior written approval from HR and Legal. Extended international remote work may have tax, labor law, and data privacy implications that must be assessed on a case-by-case basis.

12. In-Person Requirements

12.1 Hybrid Employees

Hybrid employees must be in the office on their designated in-office days. Specific in-office days are set by department:

Department	In-Office Days
Engineering	Tuesday, Thursday
Product & Design	Monday, Wednesday
Sales & Marketing	Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday
HR & Finance	Tuesday, Wednesday
Operations	Monday through Friday (on-site)

12.2 Fully Remote Employees

Fully remote employees must attend quarterly in-person team meetings (typically 2-3 days). Acme Corp will cover reasonable travel and accommodation expenses per the Expense Reimbursement Policy (ACME-FIN-001).

12.3 Company-Wide Events

All employees (including fully remote) are expected to attend the annual Acme Corp All-Hands Summit (typically held in June). Travel and accommodation expenses are covered by the company.

13. Policy Compliance

Violation of this policy may result in revocation of remote work privileges and/or disciplinary action in accordance with the Acme Corp Code of Conduct (ACME-HR-005). Employees with questions should contact HR at hr@acmecorp.com or extension x4500.

This policy is subject to change at the discretion of Acme Corp management. Employees will be notified of material changes via email and the Acme HR Portal.